MOCK TEST 59

READING

5 parts · 35 questions

60 minutes

Vaqt: 60 daqiqa. Javoblarni javoblar varaqasiga o'tkazishni unutmang.

PART 1

Questions 1–6

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

CAR FUMES

Breathing air pollution could change our brain. A study shows that car fumes can change how parts of our **Q1**_____ connect with other parts. The research is from a university in Canada. It found that car fumes can change our brain's connectivity in two hours. Professor Chris Carlsten was surprised at what he found in his **Q2**_____. He said: "For many decades, scientists thought the brain may be protected from the harmful effects of air pollution." He added: "This study provides fresh evidence supporting a connection between air pollution and thinking."

The **Q3**_____ study was on 25 adults. Researchers asked **Q4**_____ to breathe car fumes in a laboratory. The team took brain scans of the adults for two hours. The scans showed that networks in the brain that we use for thinking changed. There were fewer connections between the **Q5**_____ Another professor was worried when she saw how traffic pollution interrupted networks in the brain. She wants more research to see how car fumes change our brain. She said people should close car windows when in traffic. The brains of the 25 **Q6**_____ returned to normal after they breathed clean air.

PART 2

Questions 7–14

Read the texts 7-14 and the statements A-J. Decide which text matches with the situation described in the statements. Each statement can be used ONCE only. There are TWO extra statements which you do not need to use.

A pair is seeking a secluded retreat where they can indulge in exquisite dining experiences.

B) Your acquaintance, a qualified sailing instructor, desires employment in a location with convenient access to maritime activities.

C) You require a venue equipped with cutting-edge facilities to host large-scale corporate events.

D) Your friend, an experienced pastry chef, is searching for a position in a hotel that offers on-site living accommodations.

E) You are pursuing a managerial role in a hotel that provides opportunities for professional advancement.

F) Your colleague seeks a tranquil setting suitable for conducting a leadership workshop.

G) You and your partner are seeking a cozy seaside hotel where you can enjoy water activities together and relax in a tranquil environment.

H) You wish to spend your vacation in a destination that offers a mix of outdoor activities and cultural experiences.

I) A friend is interested in overseeing the operations of a restaurant that offers a competitive compensation package.

J) You are in search of a beachfront location where you and a small group of friends can unwind.

7

Located along a serene coastline, this boutique hotel offers 15 elegantly designed rooms, each with a private balcony overlooking the sea. The hotel features a quaint restaurant serving fresh, local seafood and offers various water activities such as kayaking and paddleboarding. Ideal for couples and small groups looking to unwind by the beach. For inquiries, email info@seasidehaven.com.

8

This charming inn is positioned just a short distance from a lively marina, providing guests with the opportunity to partake in various water sports, including sailing lessons available at the nearby harbor. For additional details, visit www.harborinn.co.uk.

9

Set amidst the heart of natural surroundings, this lodge is an ideal escape for enthusiasts of nature and outdoor adventures. Guests can explore hiking trails, enjoy bird watching, and delve into the cultural heritage of a nearby site. Reserve your stay at greenwoodlodge.com.

10

This contemporary venue is fully equipped to meet the demands of large corporate gatherings, offering expansive conference rooms, dining facilities, and comprehensive technical support. Its peaceful location with scenic surroundings makes it an excellent choice for workshops and seminars. Contact us at cedarwoodconference.com.

11

Located at the heart of the city, The Grand Hotel offers luxurious accommodations paired with all the necessary amenities for hosting significant corporate events. The hotel features multiple banquet halls and conference spaces capable of accommodating events of various scales. For more details, call 020 7946 0860.

12

A family-operated establishment located in a picturesque village, this inn is currently seeking a committed chef to join its small yet skilled team. The role includes accommodation and offers potential for career growth in a nurturing environment. Inquiries can be made by calling 01483 923456.

13

Tucked away in a remote location, this 16th-century manor exudes a romantic ambiance, featuring candlelit dinners with gourmet local cuisine and personalized service tailored for couples. For more information, visit foxhillmanor.co.uk.

14

This seaside hotel is in search of an experienced assistant manager to assist in overseeing daily operations. The ideal candidate will have a background in hospitality management and a drive to advance their career within the industry. Submit your CV to seaviewhotel@jobs.co.uk.

PART 3

Questions 15–20

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

List of Headings:

A) An array of diverse species
B) Embodying endurance
C) Multifaceted roles in society
D) Flourishing in extreme climates
E) Origins in barren terrains
F) From arid wilderness to urban spaces
G) Beyond ordinary flora
H) Evolutionary mastery

15. Paragraph 15 **16. Paragraph 16** **17. Paragraph 17**
18. Paragraph 18 **19. Paragraph 19** **20. Paragraph 20**

CACTUS

15. Cacti are renowned for their capacity to thrive under some of the planet's most challenging conditions. Predominantly found in desert regions, these plants have developed an array of adaptations that allow them to endure extreme temperatures and prolonged periods of drought. Their thick, waxy epidermis minimizes water loss, while their spines provide both protection and a form of shade. Despite the harsh environments they inhabit, cacti demonstrate remarkable longevity, often surviving for several decades or more.

16. Cacti serve a multitude of purposes across different cultures. In Mexican cuisine, the fruit of the prickly pear, known as "tuna," is a common ingredient. Traditional medicine also makes use of cactus extracts to treat various ailments, including digestive issues and skin conditions. Additionally, the spines of certain cacti have been used in crafts and jewelry. The distinctive form of the cactus has also inspired modern design, influencing everything from furniture to architectural structures. This versatility has cemented the cactus's place in both traditional and contemporary culture.

17. The cactus has its roots in the arid landscapes of the Americas, where it has thrived for millions of years. Fossil evidence suggests that the ancestors of today's cacti were present over 30 million years ago. These resilient plants are now widespread, from the deserts of the southwestern United States to the harsh, dry environments of the Atacama Desert in Chile. The cactus's ability to flourish in such desolate areas underscores its evolutionary prowess.

18. The cactus has come to symbolize resilience and perseverance, often regarded as a metaphor for strength in adversity. Its capacity to not only survive but also thrive in the most unforgiving environments has made it an emblem of toughness and endurance. In literature and visual arts, the cactus is frequently used to represent these qualities, embodying the spirit of overcoming challenges and persisting against all odds.

19. Although cacti originate from some of the world's driest regions, they have gained popularity as decorative plants in both residential and commercial spaces globally. Their striking, often unconventional appearances, combined with their minimal care requirements, have made them a favorite among gardeners and interior designers. In urban environments, cacti are frequently incorporated into landscaping to introduce an exotic element. Certain species, such as the Christmas cactus, have even been cultivated to bloom indoors during the colder months, adding a touch of vibrancy to winter settings.

20. The cactus family exhibits an extraordinary range of species, each uniquely adapted to its surroundings. From the towering saguaro of the Sonoran Desert to the diminutive, spherical peyote, these plants have undergone significant evolutionary diversification. Some species, like the saguaro, grow to impressive heights, resembling trees, while others remain compact and close to the ground. This remarkable diversity not only aids in their survival but also makes cacti highly sought after by horticulturists and enthusiasts around the globe.

PART 4

Questions 21–29

Read the following text for questions 21-29.

ANCIENT STORYTELLING

It was told, we suppose, to people crouched around a fire: a tale of adventure, most likely-relating some close encounter with death; a remarkable hunt, an escape from mortal danger; a vision, or something else out of the ordinary. Whatever its thread, the weaving of this story was done with a prime purpose. The listeners must be kept listening. They must not fall asleep. So, as the story went on, its audience should be sustained by one question above all. What happens next?

The first fireside stories in human history can never be known. They were kept in the heads of those who told them. This method of storage is not necessarily inefficient. From documented oral traditions in Australia, the Balkans and other parts of the world we know that specialised storytellers and poets can recite from memory literally thousands of lines, in verse or prose, verbatim-word for word. But while memory is rightly considered an art in itself, it is clear that a primary purpose of making symbols is to have a system of reminders or mnemonic cues – signs that assist us to recall certain

information in the mind's eye. In some Polynesian communities, a notched memory stick may help to guide a storyteller through successive stages of recitation. But in other parts of the world, the activity of storytelling historically resulted in the development or even the invention of writing systems.

One theory about the arrival of literacy in ancient Greece, for example, argues that the epic tales about the Trojan War and the wanderings of Odysseus – traditionally attributed to Homer – were just so enchanting to hear that they had to be preserved. So the Greeks, c.750-700BC, borrowed an alphabet from their neighbors in the eastern Mediterranean, the Phoenicians.

The custom of recording stories on parchment and other materials can be traced in many manifestations around the world, from the priestly papyrus archives of ancient Egypt to the birch-bark scrolls on which the North American Ojibway Indians set down their creation-myth. It is a well-tried and universal practice: so much so that to this day storytime is probably most often associated with words on paper. The formal practice of narrating a story aloud would seem-so we assume to have given way to newspapers, novels and comic strips. This, however, is not the case. Statistically, it is doubtful that the majority of humans currently rely upon the written word to get access to stories. So what is the alternative source?

Each year, over 7 billion people will go to watch the latest offering from Hollywood, Bollywood and beyond. The supreme storyteller of today is cinema. The movies, as distinct from still photography, seem to be an essential modern phenomenon. This is an illusion, for there are, as we shall see, certain ways in which the medium of film is indebted to very old precedents of arranging 'sequences' of images. But any account of visual storytelling must be with the recognition that all storytelling beats with a deeply atavistic pulse: that is, a 'good story' relies upon formal patterns of plot and characterisation that have been embedded in the practice of storytelling over many generations.

Thousands of scripts arrive every week at the offices of the major film studios. But aspiring screenwriters really need to look no further for essential advice then the fourth-century BC Greek Philosopher Aristotle. He left some incomplete lecture notes on the art of telling stories in various literary and dramatic modes, a slim volume known as The Poetics. Though he can never have envisaged the popcorn-fuelled actuality of a multiplex cinema, Aristotle is almost prescient about the key elements required to get the crowds flocking to such a cultural hub. He analyzed the process with cool rationalism. When a story enchants us, we lose the sense of where we are; we are drawn into the story so thoroughly that we forget it is a story being told. This is, in Aristotle's phrase, 'the suspension of disbelief.'

For questions 21-24, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

21 What was the main goal of the earliest fireside stories?

A) To entertain with humor
B) To keep the audience attentive and awake
C) To impart moral lessons
D) To record historical events

22 What does the passage imply about the first storytellers?

A) They heavily relied on written texts.
B) They used memory techniques to retain stories.
C) They recorded tales on parchment.
D) They avoided using symbols or cues.

23 Why did the ancient Greeks reportedly adopt an alphabet from the Phoenicians?

A) To document agricultural practices
B) To preserve epic tales like those of the Trojan War
C) To improve trade and communication
D) To create a legal system

24 According to the passage, what serves as the modern equivalent of ancient storytelling?

A) Newspapers and novels
B) Radio broadcasts
C) Cinema
D) Social media platforms

For questions 25-29, decide if the following statements agree with the information given in the text. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

25 The earliest fireside stories primarily focused on the afterlife.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

26 In some cultures, storytellers used notched sticks to help them remember the sequence of events.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

27 The ancient Greeks developed their alphabet independently, without outside influence.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

28 The Ojibway Indians recorded their creation myths on birch-bark scrolls.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

29 Aristotle's 'The Poetics' offers insights that are still relevant for modern screenwriters.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

PART 5 Questions 30–35

Read the following text for questions 30-35.

T-REX HUNTER

Jack Horner is an unlikely academic: his dyslexia is so bad that he has trouble reading a book. But he can read the imprint of life in sandstone or muddy shale across a distance of 100m years, and it is this gift that has made him curator of palaeontology at Montana State University's Museum of the Rockies, the leader of a multi-million dollar scientific project to

expose a complete slice of life 68m years ago, and a consultant to Steven Spielberg and other Hollywood figures.

His father had a sand and gravel quarry in Montana, and the young Horner was a collector of stones and bones, complete with notes about when and where he found them. "My father had owned a ranch when he was younger, in Montana," he says. "He was enough of a geologist, is a sand and gravel man, to have a pretty good notion that they were dinosaur bones. So when I was eight years old he took me back to the area that had been his ranch, to where he had seen these big old bones. I picked up one. I am pretty sure it was the upper arm bone of a duckbilled dinosaur: it probably wasn't a maiaosaur but closely related to that. I catalogued it, and took good care of it, and then later when I was in high school, excavated my first dinosaur skeleton. It obviously started earlier than eight and I literally have been driven ever since. I feel like I was born this way."

Horner spent seven years at university but never graduated. "I have a learning disability, I would call it a learning difference – dyslexia, they call it – and I just had a terrible time with English and foreign languages and things like that. For a degree in geology or biology, they required two years of a foreign language. There was no way in the world I could do that. In fact, I didn't really pass English. So I couldn't get a degree, I just wasn't capable of it. But I took all of the courses required and I wrote a thesis and I did all sorts of things. So I have the education, I just don't have the piece of paper," he says.

In Montana, in those days, everybody had the right to a college education. His grades at high school had been terrible, at university, his advisers recognised that he was having a hard time, and went on helping. The dean who kept readmitting him was to give Horner an honorary doctorate years later. As a young non-graduate, Horner wrote to every museum in the English-speaking world, asking for a job. Los Angeles County Museum and the Royal Ontario Museum in Toronto made offers, but he accepted a post as a technician at Princeton University because of Princeton, New Jersey.

"We definitely know we are working on a very broad coastal plain with the streams and rivers bordered by conifers and hardwood plants, and the areas in between these rivers were probably fern-covered. There were no grasses at all: just ferns and bushes – an unusual landscape, kind of taking the south-eastern United States – Georgia, Florida – and mixing it with the moors of England and flattening it out," he says. "Triceratops is very common: they are the cows of the Cretaceous, they are everywhere. Duckbilled dinosaurs are relatively common but not as common as triceratops and T rex, for a meat-eating dinosaur, is very common. What we would consider the predator-prey ratio seems really off the scale. What is interesting is the little dromaeosaurs, the ones we know for sure were good predators, we haven't found any of them."

Which is why he sees T rex, not as the lion of the Cretaceous savannah but its vulture. "Look at the wildebeest that migrate in the Serengeti of Africa, a million individuals lose about 200,000 individuals in that annual migration. There is a tremendous carrion base there. And so you have hyenas, you have tremendous numbers of vultures that are scavenging, you don't have all that many animals that are good predators. If T rex was a top predator, especially considering how big it is, you'd expect it to be extremely rare, much rarer than the little dromaeosaurs, and yet they are everywhere, they are a dime a dozen," he says. A 12-tonne T rex is a lot of vultures, but he doesn't see the monster as clumsy. He insisted his theory and finding, dedicated to further research upon it, of course, he would like to reevaluate if there is any case that additional evidence found or explanation raised by others in the future.

For questions 30-33, fill in the missing information in the numbered spaces. Write no more than ONE WORD and / or A NUMBER for each question.

Horner serves as the curator of palaeontology at Montana State University's Museum of the **30** _____. At the age of eight, Horner discovered what he believed to be the upper arm bone of a **31** _____ dinosaur. Horner faced challenges with **32** _____ due to his dyslexia, preventing him from earning a degree. Horner likens the T-Rex to a **33** _____, suggesting it scavenged like vultures rather than actively hunted.

For questions 34-35, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

34 Why was Horner unable to complete his university education?

A) He was dismissed for low academic performance.
B) He couldn't meet the foreign language requirements.
C) He lost enthusiasm for his studies.
D) He failed to submit his thesis.

35 What is Horner's reasoning for considering T-Rex more of a scavenger?

A) It lacked the speed to catch live prey.
B) It was too massive to function as a top predator.
C) It was found more frequently than smaller, known predators.
D) Its teeth were more suitable for scavenging than for hunting.

MOCK TEST 59

35 answers

1 brain
2 research
3 pollution / brain
4 adults
5 networks
6 people
7 G
8 B
9 H
10 F
11 C
12 D
13 A
14 E
15 D
16 C
17 E
18 B
19 F
20 A
21 B / To keep the audience attentive and awake
22 B / They used memory techniques to retain stories.
23 B / To preserve epic tales like those of the Trojan War
24 C / Cinema
25 Not Given
26 True
27 False
28 True
29 True
30 rocks / Rockies
31 duckbilled
32 English
33 vulture
34 B / He couldn't meet the foreign language requirements.
35 C / It was found more frequently than smaller, known predators.